A-A-2338
September 20, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPADE (GARDENING TYPE)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Type XI, Class A, Style 3 and Type XI, Class B, Style 1 of Federal Specification GG-S-326.

This commercial item description covers digging implements suitable for cultivating dirt.

Salient characteristics.

Type I - D handle
  Style 1 - solid shank
Type II - Long handle
  style 2 - open back

Blade. The blade shall be made of high grade steel with a smooth, rust free finish. The cutting edge shall be sharpened or beveled in accordance with good commercial practice.

Measurements. The dimensions of the spade shall be measured in accordance with the illustrations in Figure 1.

Hardness. The blade and shank shall be heat treated to a hardness of Rockwell C 40 to 47 in accordance with ASTM E18.

Handle. The handle shall be seasoned hardwood such as ash or hickory, finished in accordance with good commercial practice.

Rivets. The handle shall be secured in the socket with a minimum of one round headed rivet which shall not be smaller than Size No. 6. The rivet(s) shall be smoothly finished flush with the surface of the shank.

Coating. The handle shall be completely covered with a clear coat of lacquer or varnish to prevent the absorption of water.

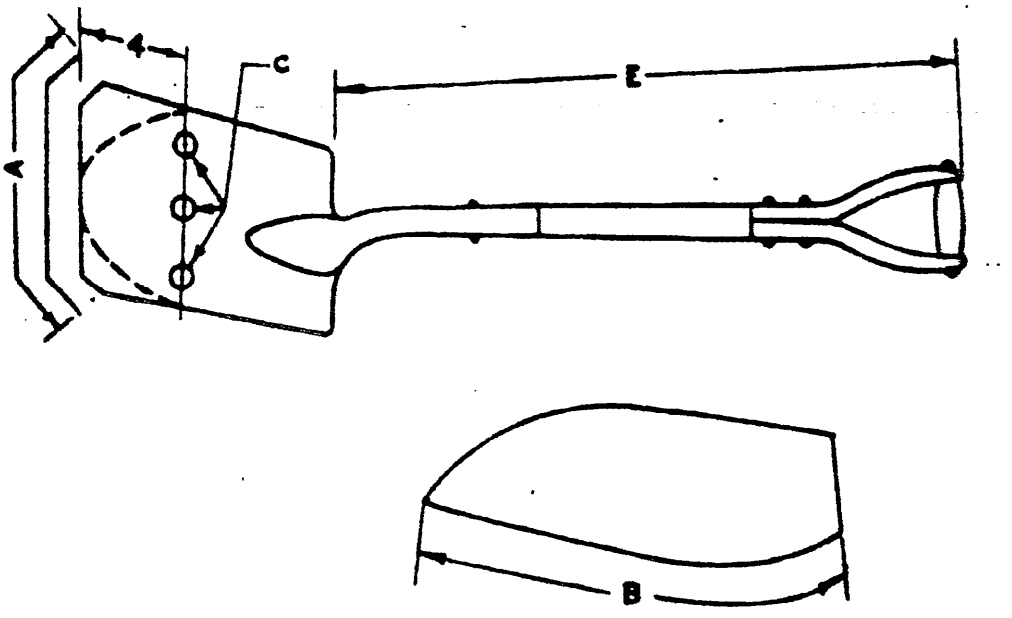
Replacement handle. Handles for replacement shall be tapered and slotted at the shank end to conform to the dimensions of the socket. The handle shall be furnished with two round head rivets.

Identification. The handle shall be legibly and permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

Load test. With the blade firmly supported on a horizontal surface, the handle shall support a 176-pound load suspended 26 inches from the Type II blade shoulder. The load shall be suspended from the handgrip of the Type I spade. The load shall be supported for 120 seconds without damage to the spade or a decrease in measured lift of more than one inch.

FSC 3750

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



A Blade width is the largest measurement obtained following the curvature of the blade.
B Blade length.
C Blade thickness.
D Strap or socket length.
E Handle length from shoulder of blade to end of handle.
F Handle lift.

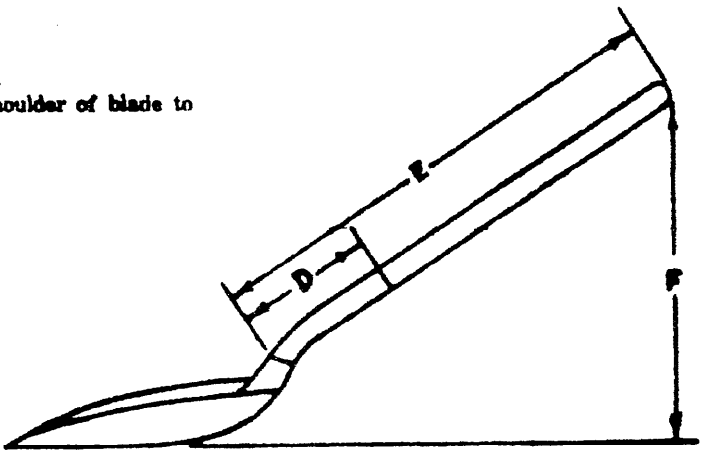


FIGURE 1.—Method of measuring.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type I spade. The Type I spade shall be similar to Figure 2 with dimensions in accordance with Table I.

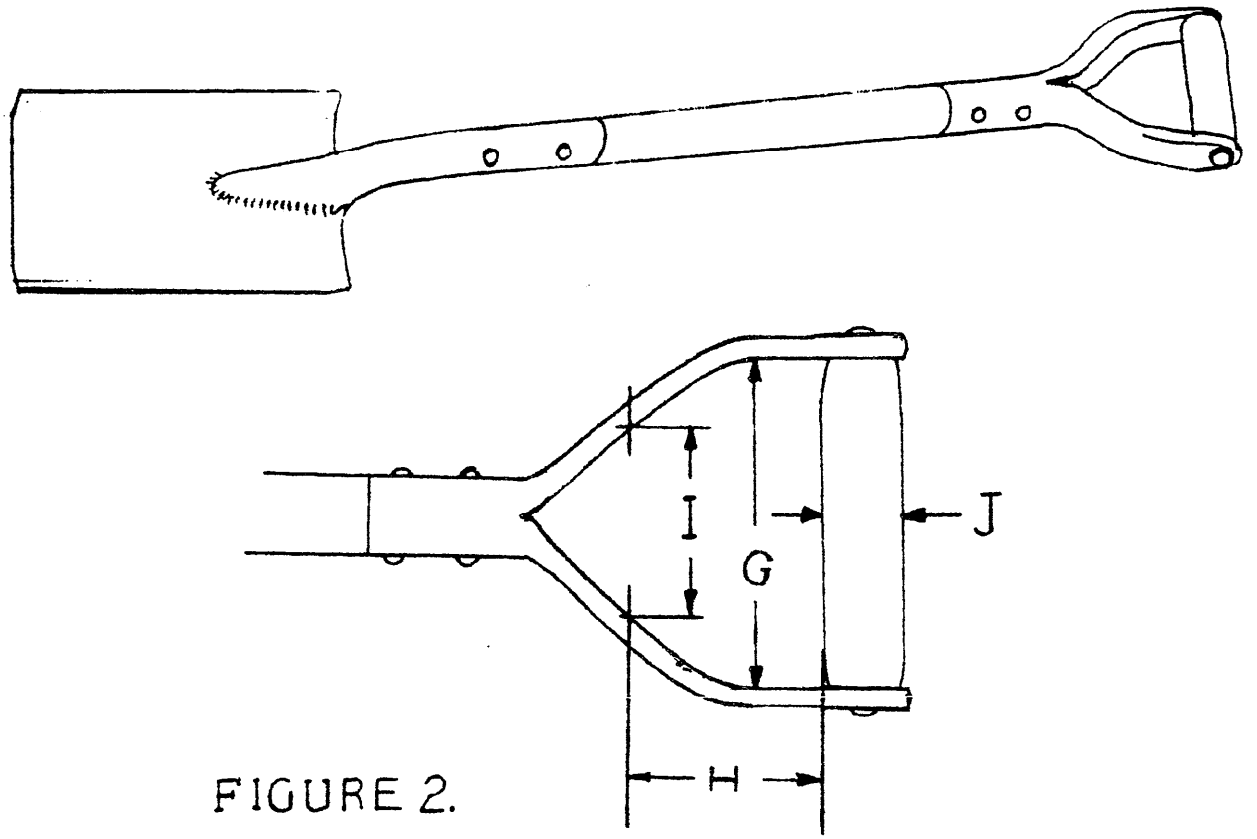


FIGURE 2.

TABLE I

Blade Width A inches	Blade Length B inches	Blade Thickness C inches	Socket Length D inches	Handle Length E inches	Lift F inches	Handgrip Width G inches	Support Length H inches	I inches	Handgrip diameter J inches
7 to 8	11-3/8 to 12-3/4	0.0747 to 0.0897	8-3/4 min.	26 to 28	9-1/2 to 12-1/2	3-3/4 min.	2-1/2 min.	1-3/4 min.	1-15/32 min.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

D-Handle. The handle end shall be -t.rutted of a tubular steel support with a smoothly finished ash or hickory handgrip secured to prevent loosening or turning.

Securement. The handgrip shall be secured to the handle with a flush-finished, roundheaded rivet if the handle prongs extend through the support tubes. If the handle prongs do not extend through the handle tubes, then a minimum of two rivets shall be required.

Solid shank The shank shall be formed from one piece of steel so that the blade, shank, and socket will be integral.

Blade. The spade shall have a straight inside taper to receive the handle. The handle shall be secured in the socket with a round head rivet smoothly finished flush to the surfaces of the shank.

Type II Spade. The Type II spade shall be similar to Figure 3 with dimensions in accordance with Table II. The blade diensions shall be in accordance with Table 1 when measured in accordance with Figure 1.

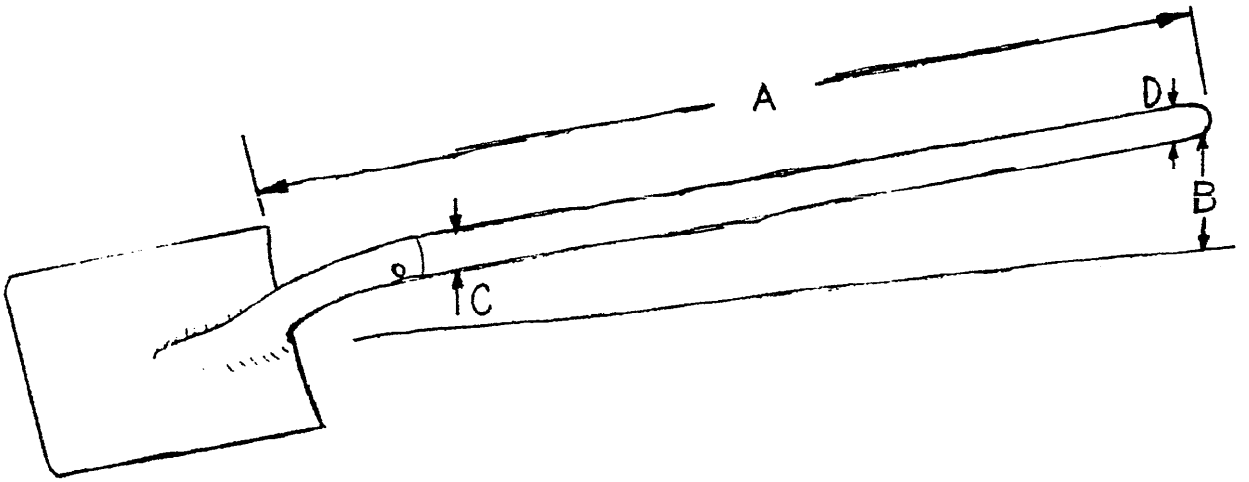


FIGURE 3.

TABLE II

Handle Length A inches	Lift B inches	Handle diameter C inches	Handle diameter D inches
46 to 52	16 to 20	1-7/16 min.	1 min.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Blade. The shank and blade shall be formed from one piece of steel, smoothly arched and curved to form an integral socket at the center of the shoulder. The back of the blade shall be hollow or recessed at the shank and blade juncture.

Socket. The socket shall be closed to a minimum 3/16 inch width seam for minimum length of 6-3/4 inches.

shoulder. The blade shoulder shall be smoothly turned into a non-cutting step.

Worhanship. The spades shall be free from defects which will impair their appearance, durability, or serviceability.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Notes. This commercial item description does cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this commercial item description, or of those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types normally procured to meet federal requirement.

Purchaser should specify styles and sizes in contract or ordering documents.

The specification/commercial item description contains no warranty provision, and no commercial warranty is known to exist.

The commercial item certification clause is not required when this commercial item description is used for procurement.

Copies of ASTM E 18 are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians
Army -ME
Air Force - 99

Review Activity
Air Force - 84

User Activities
Army-ME
Navy-YD
Air Force - 99

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026l0-26T08:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.